Date: 20/10/2026 **SAI DATTA BHAAVAN MBNP**
241401087 B.Tech CSBS

AI AND ANALYTICS USING ZIA

AIM

To add artificial-intelligence features to a Zoho Creator application using Zia's AI fields, by adding Sentiment Analysis and Keyword Extraction fields to the Loan Application form so that the text an applicant writes as the purpose of the loan is analysed automatically on submission.

PROCEDURE

1. Background

Zia is Zoho's built-in AI assistant. Inside Zoho Creator, Zia is made available to app builders as AI fields: special form fields that take the value of an ordinary field (the source field), send it to a Zia model, and store the answer in the new field. No code or model training is needed for the text-analysis fields, and the result appears in the record like any other field value. The AI Fields section of the Form Builder in the account used for this lab offered the following fields:

AI field	What it does
Sentiment Analysis	Reads a text field and classifies its tone, for example Positive, Negative or Neutral
Keyword Extraction	Reads a text field and returns its important words and phrases
Prediction	Predicts a value for a record from patterns in existing data; needs a set of past records to learn from
OCR	Reads text out of an uploaded image
Object Detection	Identifies objects in an uploaded image

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2. How the Two Text Analyses Work

Both fields rely on natural language processing (NLP), the branch of AI that works with human language. Sentiment analysis breaks the sentence into words and phrases and scores their emotional tone, then assigns the whole text to a class such as Positive, Negative or Neutral. Keyword extraction ranks the words and phrases of a text by importance and returns the top ones, ignoring common filler words. Because the model is supplied by Zia, the app builder only chooses the source field; the model itself is not trained or tuned in Creator.

3. Design for the Loan Application App

A loan application contains a free-text field, Purpose_of_Loan, in which the applicant explains why the money is needed. Reading each of these by hand is slow for a screening team. Two AI fields were therefore attached to that single source field:

New field	Type	Source field and use
Purpose_Sentiment	Sentiment Analysis	Purpose_of_Loan – shows the tone of the stated purpose
Purpose_Keywords	Keyword Extraction	Purpose_of_Loan – shows the main topics, which can be used to group or search applications

The two fields use text analysis only, because they need no extra data. Prediction was not used because it needs a larger history of records to learn from, and OCR and Object Detection were not used because the form has no image field.

4. Adding the Sentiment Analysis Field

- Open Loan_Application_Form in the Form Builder.
- In the left palette expand AI Fields and drag Sentiment Analysis onto the form, below the existing fields.
- In Field Properties set Field name to Purpose_Sentiment. The Source Field is shown as Purpose_of_Loan.
- Change the Field link name from the default Sentiment to Purpose_Sentiment so that it matches the field name.

5. Adding the Keyword Extraction Field

- Drag Keyword Extraction from the AI Fields section onto the form.
- Set Field name to Purpose_Keywords and the Field link name to Purpose_Keywords. The Source Field is Purpose_of_Loan.
- Click Done to save the form.

Both fields are filled by Zia, not by the applicant. They were left without any input when the form was submitted.

6. Testing

The form was opened in access mode and a new application was submitted. The entry in Purpose_of_Loan was “For the purchase of the new MRF cricket kit” and the Pincode was 500001. After submission the record was opened from the Loan_Application_Form Report to read the values stored in the AI fields.

Field	Value stored after submission
Purpose_of_Loan (input)	For the purchase of the new MRF cricket kit
Purpose_Sentiment (Zia)	Positive
Purpose_Keywords (Zia)	MRF cricket kit, purchase
verified_location (workflow from Exp-07)	Hyderabad, Telangana

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7. Observations

- The Source Field cannot be typed into once the AI field is placed; Zia picked up Purpose_of_Loan as the text to analyse, and it is shown greyed out in Field Properties.
- Zia returned the answer when the record was submitted, so the report shows the sentiment and keywords next to the applicant’s own data.
- The keywords were the meaningful words of the sentence (MRF cricket kit, purchase) and left out filler words such as “for” and “the”.
- The AI fields work together with the earlier experiments: the same record also carries the Pincode verification added in Exp-07.
- Only one test record was submitted for this report, so the behaviour for negative or neutral wording was not recorded.

8. Possible Uses in Loan Screening

- A Negative sentiment value could trigger a workflow that flags the application for manual review, in the same way that Risk_flag is set in Exp-06.
- Keywords can be used to filter reports, for example to find every application whose purpose mentions education or business.
- A report or chart grouped by Purpose_Sentiment would show the mix of Positive, Negative and Neutral applications on the dashboard.

9. Advantages and Limitations

Advantages	Limitations observed or expected
No code and no model training needed for the text fields	Works on one source field at a time; the source cannot be changed from the field once placed
Result is stored in the record, so it can be used in reports, filters and workflows	Quality depends on the wording; short or ambiguous text may give a weak result
Saves the screening team from reading every free-text entry	Only one test record was recorded here, so accuracy was not measured
Works together with the other features of the app (workflows, reports)	AI fields depend on the plan and region of the account

10. Data and Privacy Considerations

A loan application holds personal and financial information. Only the text of the source field, Purpose_of_Loan, is analysed by the AI fields, so no PAN number, contact detail or income value is used as input. In a real deployment the free-text field should be reviewed so that applicants are not asked to type personal identifiers into it, and the permission sets created in Exp-08 should control which users can see the AI results.

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OUTPUT

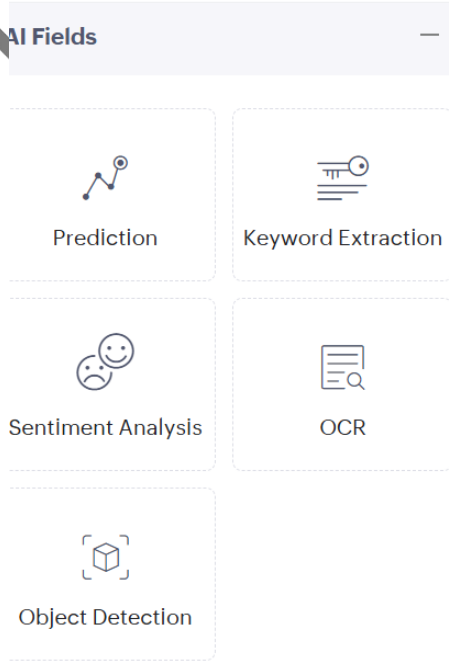


Fig. 1: AI Fields section of the Form Builder – Prediction, Keyword Extraction, Sentiment Analysis, OCR and Object Detection

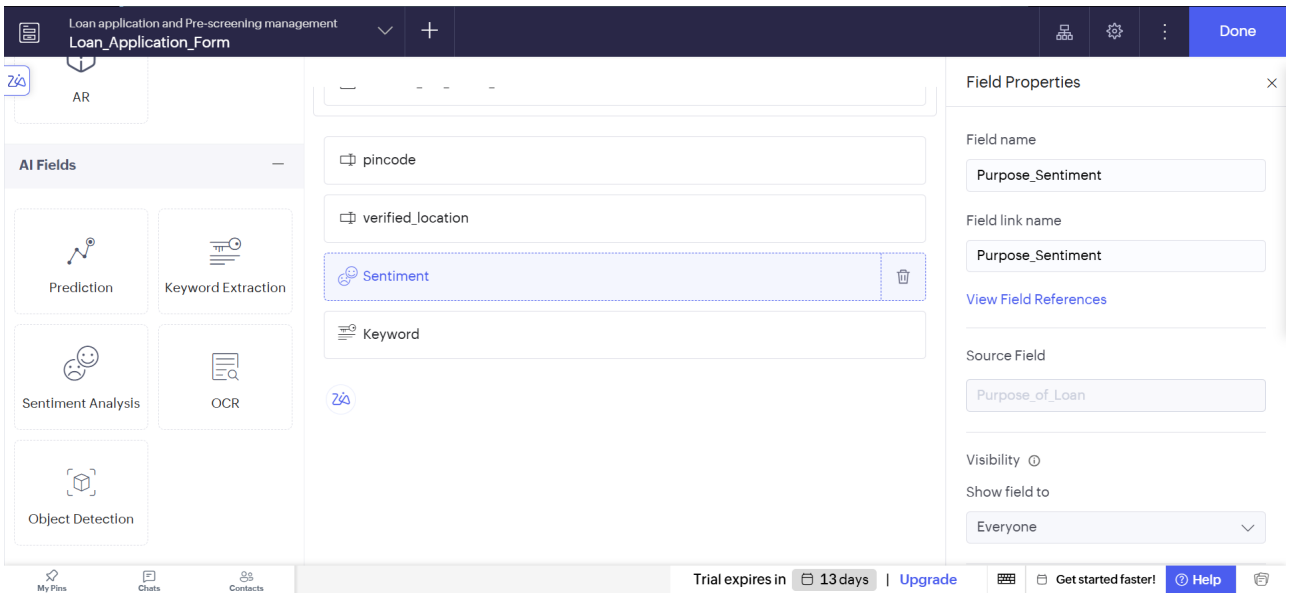


Fig. 2: Form Builder – Purpose_Sentiment (Sentiment Analysis) with Source Field Purpose_of_Loan, and the Purpose_Keywords field below it

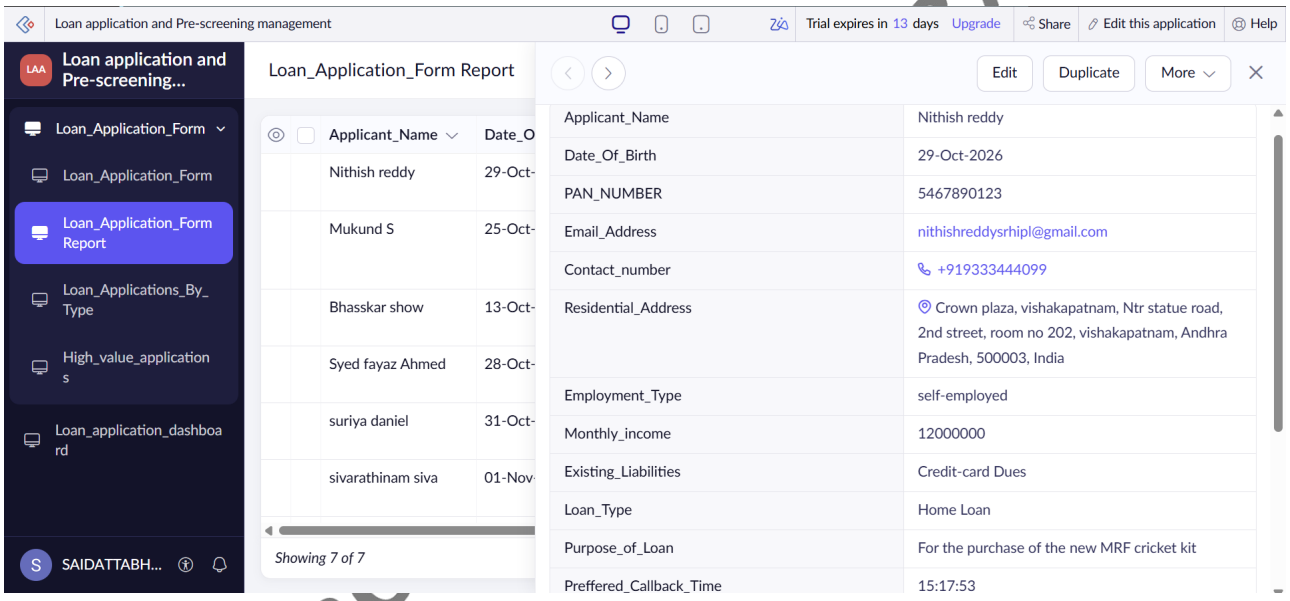


Fig. 3: Report record – applicant details and the Purpose_of_Loan entry that Zia analysed

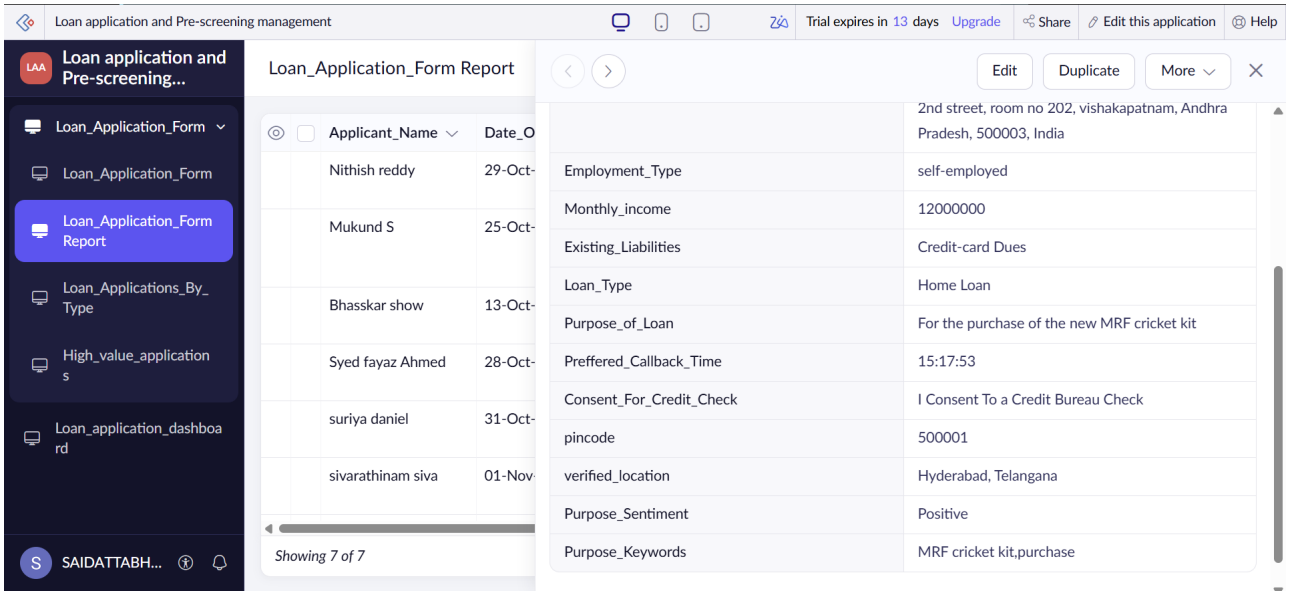


Fig. 4: Same record – Zia filled Purpose_Sentiment = Positive and Purpose_Keywords = "MRF cricket kit, purchase"

RESULT

Sentiment Analysis and Keyword Extraction AI fields were added to the Loan Application form of the Zoho Creator app, both using Purpose_of_Loan as their source. On submission of a test application, Zia automatically stored the sentiment (Positive) and the keywords (MRF cricket kit, purchase) in the record, as seen in the report. Thus AI-based analysis of applicant text using Zia was successfully implemented in Zoho Creator.

Conclusion

AI fields let a low-code application add language intelligence with a few clicks. For the loan application, Zia's sentiment and keyword results give screening staff an instant summary of every applicant's stated purpose, and they can feed the workflows, reports and access rules built in the earlier experiments.

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